

Company Leave & Time-Off Policy

Sample HR Policy Document for HR Copilot AI Testing

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Leave and Time-Off Policy is to provide employees with reasonable opportunities to take time away from work for rest, personal responsibilities, illness, family needs, emergencies, and other approved purposes.

The company believes that regular time off is important for employee well-being, productivity, and maintaining a healthy work-life balance. This policy defines the different types of leave available to eligible employees, the process for requesting leave, approval requirements, documentation requirements, and employee responsibilities.

This policy applies to all eligible full-time and part-time employees unless a different employment agreement, local law, or specific company policy provides otherwise.

2. General Leave Rules

Employees are expected to request planned leave in advance through the company's approved leave management system or by following the process communicated by the Human Resources department.

Employees should ensure that their managers are informed about planned absences and should make reasonable efforts to complete urgent work or arrange an appropriate handover before beginning leave.

Approval of leave may depend on business requirements, team workload, availability of other employees, the type and duration of leave requested, available leave balance, prior leave commitments, and applicable legal or statutory requirements.

Employees should not assume that leave is approved until confirmation has been received from the appropriate manager, HR department, or authorized leave management system.

3. Annual or Earned Leave

Eligible full-time employees are entitled to **24 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year**. Annual leave is intended to allow employees to take extended periods of rest, travel, personal time, or vacation. Employees are encouraged to plan annual leave in advance whenever possible.

Annual Leave Request Requirements:

Employees should normally submit a request at least 3 working days in advance for leave of 1–2 days, at least 2 weeks in advance for leave of 3–5 consecutive working days, and at least 30 days in advance for leave exceeding 5 consecutive working days. Managers may approve or decline requests depending on operational requirements.

Carry Forward:

Employees may carry forward up to 10 unused annual leave days into the following calendar year.

Carried-forward leave should normally be used within the first six months of the new calendar year. Any remaining balance after this period may expire unless an exception is approved by HR or required by applicable law.

4. Casual Leave

Employees are entitled to **12 days of paid casual leave per calendar year**. Casual leave may be used for short-term personal requirements, including personal appointments, family responsibilities, urgent household matters, unexpected personal commitments, religious or cultural events, and other short-duration personal needs.

Employees should inform their manager as early as possible. Casual leave should normally not be used for extended vacations or planned long-term absences. A maximum of 3 consecutive working days of casual leave may normally be taken at one time unless additional approval is provided. Unused casual leave generally cannot be carried forward into the following year.

5. Sick Leave

Eligible employees are entitled to **12 days of paid sick leave per calendar year**. Sick leave may be used when an employee is unable to perform their normal work duties because of illness, injury, or a medical condition.

Employees should notify their manager or designated contact as soon as reasonably possible, preferably before the start of their scheduled working hours. For absences lasting more than 3 consecutive working days, the company may request appropriate medical documentation or a fitness-to-return certificate, subject to applicable law and privacy requirements.

Employees should not be required to disclose unnecessary confidential medical information to their direct manager. Medical documentation should be provided to HR where appropriate. Unused sick leave may not normally be carried forward unless required by applicable law or specifically approved under another company policy.

6. Emergency Leave

Emergency leave may be granted when an employee experiences an unexpected situation requiring immediate attention. Examples may include serious illness or accident involving an immediate family member, medical emergencies, natural disasters, significant damage to the employee's home, unexpected family emergencies, or other exceptional personal circumstances.

Employees should notify their manager as soon as possible. The company may provide up to **3 days of paid emergency leave per calendar year**, depending on the circumstances. Additional time may be considered as annual leave, unpaid leave, or another applicable leave category.

7. Bereavement Leave

Employees may receive paid bereavement leave following the death of an immediate family member. Immediate family may include a spouse or domestic partner, parent or legal guardian, child, sibling, grandparent, parent-in-law, or other dependent family members.

Eligible employees may receive up to **5 working days of paid bereavement leave**. Additional unpaid leave or annual leave may be requested when additional time is required for travel, family responsibilities, funeral arrangements, or emotional recovery. The company may request reasonable documentation where necessary.

8. Parental Leave

The company supports employees who become parents through birth, adoption, or other legally recognized arrangements.

Maternity Leave:

Eligible employees may receive maternity leave in accordance with applicable laws and company benefits. Employees are encouraged to notify HR as early as reasonably possible so that leave arrangements and workplace planning can be completed.

Paternity or Partner Leave:

Eligible employees may receive **10 working days of paid partner or paternity leave**, subject to company eligibility requirements and applicable law.

Adoption Leave:

Employees who legally adopt a child may be eligible for parental or adoption leave under the same or similar conditions provided to other eligible parents. The exact duration, payment, eligibility, and documentation requirements may depend on applicable laws and company policies.

9. Unpaid Leave

Employees who have exhausted their available paid leave or require an extended absence may request unpaid leave. Approval of unpaid leave is not automatic and will depend on the reason for the request, duration of the requested absence, operational requirements, previous leave history, applicable laws, and approval from management and HR.

During unpaid leave, certain employee benefits may be affected depending on the duration of the absence and applicable company policies. Employees should contact HR before beginning an extended period of unpaid leave.

10. Leave During Probation

Employees who are serving a probationary period may be eligible for certain types of leave based on company rules and applicable laws. Annual leave may accrue during probation but may require manager approval before it can be used. Sick leave and emergency leave may generally be available when employees meet the applicable eligibility requirements.

Taking extended leave during probation may result in the probation period being extended where permitted by company policy and applicable law.

11. Public Holidays

The company observes designated public holidays according to the applicable office location and official company holiday calendar. Employees are not normally required to use annual or casual leave

for approved company holidays.

If business requirements require an employee to work on a designated public holiday, the employee may be eligible for compensatory time off, additional payment, or another form of benefit. The applicable arrangement will depend on company policy, employment terms, and local legal requirements.

12. Compensatory Time Off

Employees who are officially required and authorized to work outside their normal working schedule may be eligible for compensatory time off. Employees must obtain prior approval from their manager before working additional hours or on a designated holiday unless the situation is an emergency.

Compensatory leave should normally be used within **60 days** of the approved additional work. Unused compensatory time may expire after the specified validity period unless an exception is approved.

13. Leave Request and Approval Process

Employees should submit leave requests through the designated HR system. A leave request should include the type of leave, start date, end date, number of working days, relevant reason or category where required, and supporting documentation where applicable.

Managers should review requests as soon as reasonably possible. Employees should wait for approval before making non-refundable travel or other commitments when leave approval is required. Approval may be denied or alternative dates may be suggested when multiple employees request leave during the same critical business period.

14. Unexpected Absence

If an employee is unable to attend work unexpectedly, they must notify their manager or designated contact as soon as possible. Where practical, notification should include the reason for the absence, expected duration if known, whether urgent work requires reassignment, and the best method for contacting the employee if necessary.

Repeated failure to notify the company about an absence may be treated as an unauthorized absence.

15. Unauthorized Absence

An absence may be considered unauthorized when an employee fails to request required leave, does not receive approval for planned leave, fails to report to work without explanation, does not communicate during an extended unexplained absence, or provides false information or documentation regarding leave.

Unauthorized absences may result in unpaid time and may also lead to disciplinary action according to the company's disciplinary policy.

16. Leave Balance and Accrual

Employees can review their available leave balance through the company's HR or employee management system. Leave balances may be calculated based on employment start date, length of service, employment type, leave already taken, company leave year, and accrual rules.

New employees who join during the middle of a calendar year may receive leave on a prorated basis. Employees are responsible for reviewing their leave balance before submitting requests.

17. Cancellation or Modification of Leave

Employees who need to cancel or modify approved leave should update their request as soon as possible. The company may also request changes to planned leave in exceptional business circumstances. Where possible, reasonable notice will be provided.

If an employee becomes ill during approved annual leave, the employee may request that eligible days be converted to sick leave, subject to providing required documentation and following the company's reporting procedures.

18. Extended Leave and Return to Work

Employees taking extended leave may be required to coordinate with their manager regarding work handover, project status, temporary reassignment of responsibilities, company equipment, expected return date, and contact arrangements during leave.

Employees returning from extended medical or statutory leave may be required to provide documentation confirming their ability to return to work, where legally permitted and reasonably necessary. The company will make reasonable efforts to support employees returning from extended leave.

19. Contact During Leave

Employees are generally not expected to perform normal work duties while on approved leave. However, for critical roles or exceptional circumstances, employees may be contacted regarding urgent business matters where appropriate.

Managers should respect employees' approved time off and avoid unnecessary work-related communication. Employees should not be required to regularly check emails, messages, or complete normal work tasks while on approved leave unless specifically agreed in advance.

20. Policy Exceptions

The company recognizes that exceptional circumstances may require flexibility. Requests for exceptions to this policy should be discussed with the employee's manager and HR department.

Exceptions may be considered based on serious personal circumstances, medical requirements, legal obligations, business needs, or other exceptional situations. Approval of an exception in one situation does not automatically create an entitlement to the same exception in future cases.

21. Policy Review and Changes

The company may review, modify, suspend, or update this Leave and Time-Off Policy when necessary to reflect changes in employment laws, business requirements, organizational growth, employee feedback, or changes to company benefits.

Employees will be informed of significant changes through official company communication channels.

Sample Questions for HR Copilot AI Testing

- How many casual leaves do I get in a year?
- Can I carry forward my unused annual leave?
- I am sick for 5 days. Do I need to provide a medical certificate?
- Can I take 7 consecutive days of annual leave?
- What happens if I take leave without approval?
- How much bereavement leave can I get?
- Can I take emergency leave for a family medical emergency?
- What happens if I become sick while on annual leave?
- Can my manager contact me while I am on approved leave?
- What happens if I have used all my paid leave but need more time off?